

Maria Jose Saborio Espinoza

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SUMMARY

Compassionate and dedicated Animal Care Professional with over five years of experience in wildlife nutrition, rehabilitation, veterinary assistance, and daily care of more than 20 wildlife species. Experienced in providing specialized nutritional support, assisting veterinarians during medical procedures, administering treatments under veterinary supervision, supervising volunteers and staff, and maintaining exceptional standards of animal welfare. Passionate about wildlife conservation and committed to supporting the recovery, rehabilitation, and long-term well-being of rescued animals.

EDUCATION

General Educational Development (GED)

Currently in Progress

EXPERIENCE

Wildlife Nutrition Coordinator & Animal Care Specialist

September 19, 2021 – Present

Refugio Animal Costa Rica

- Lead the wildlife nutrition program by preparing and managing species-specific diets that support animal health, recovery, and rehabilitation.
- Provide daily husbandry and medical support for more than 20 species of wildlife, including monkeys, sloths, big cats, parrots, toucans, reptiles, and other native and exotic animals.
- Assist veterinarians with physical examinations, diagnostic procedures, treatments, and rehabilitation plans.
- Administer intravenous (IV) fluids, medications, and supportive treatments under veterinary supervision.
- Perform safe animal restraint techniques during medical procedures, health evaluations, and transportation.
- Provide specialized care for neonatal and juvenile wildlife requiring intensive feeding and monitoring.
- Observe animal behavior, appetite, physical condition, and recovery progress, reporting changes promptly to veterinary staff.
- Train and mentor volunteers in animal handling, feeding protocols, sanitation procedures, enrichment activities, and safety standards.
- Supervise volunteers and employees to ensure consistent, high-quality animal care and operational efficiency.
- Maintain clean, secure, and enriched enclosures that promote animal welfare and natural behaviors.
- Follow strict food safety, sanitation, and biosecurity procedures throughout food preparation and animal care operations.
- Participate in wildlife rescue, rehabilitation, capture, transportation, and release efforts as needed.
- Assist with educational activities and interact professionally with visitors, helping promote wildlife conservation and environmental awareness.
- Respond effectively to emergency situations while maintaining calm, professional decision-making.

Driver Assistant

Previous Position

Student Transportation Service

- Assisted with the safe transportation of school children between schools and their homes.
- Ensured student safety during boarding, transportation, and drop-off.
- Demonstrated reliability, responsibility, and excellent communication with parents, students, and drivers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Wildlife Nutrition Management

Wildlife Rehabilitation

Wildlife Animal Handling

Animal Welfare & Behavioral Enrichment
Veterinary Assistance
Intravenous (IV) Fluid Administration
Medication Administration
Animal Health Monitoring
Animal Restraint Techniques
Neonatal Animal Care
Capture & Safe Animal Transport
Enclosure Maintenance
Food Safety & Sanitation
Feeding Preparation & Diet Management
Volunteer Training & Supervision
Staff Leadership
Public Education & Visitor Interaction
Record Keeping
Emergency Animal Care
Team Collaboration
Bilingual Communication (Spanish & English)

CERTIFICATIONS

Wildlife Animal Handling Specialist
First Aid Certification
Additional Training in Wildlife Care and Animal Handling

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native English: Professional Working Proficiency